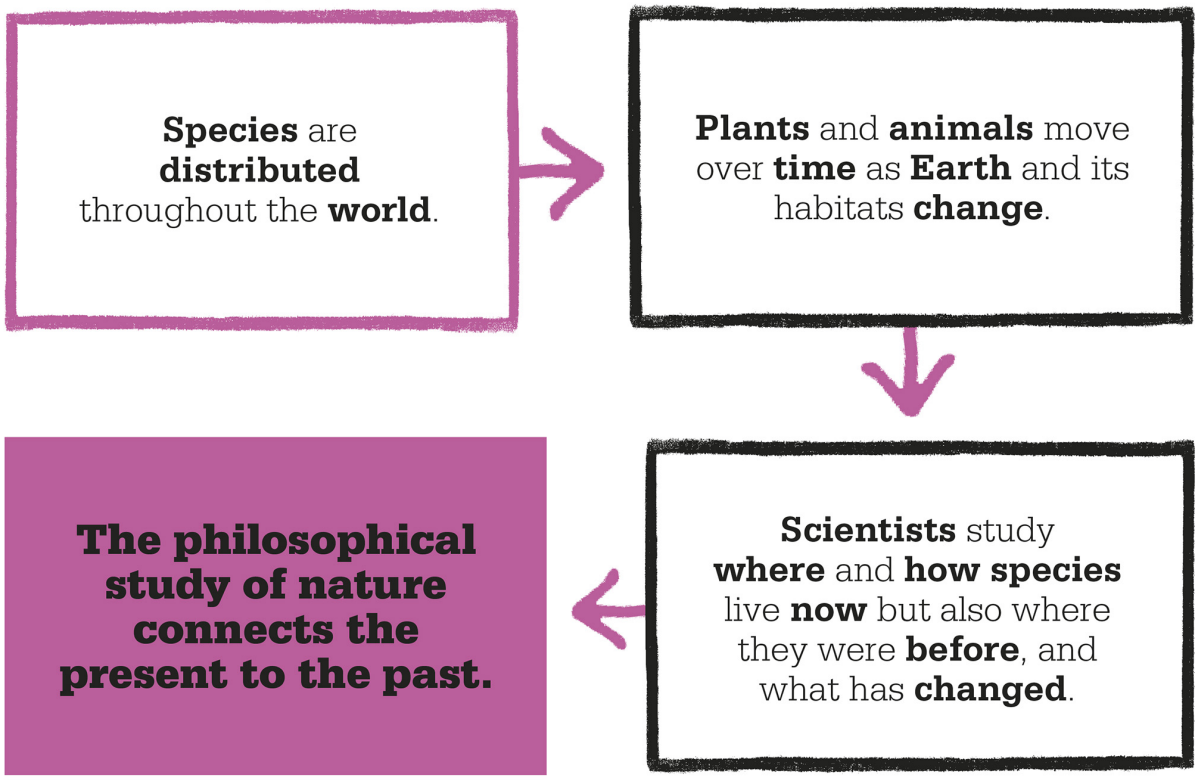
is called biogeography. Biogeography is also concerned with how and why the patterns of distribution change over time.

Early zoologists and botanists such as Carl Linnaeus were well aware of geographical variations in species' distributions, but the first to make detailed studies of this aspect of zoology was the Prussian polymath Alexander von Humboldt, who traveled to Latin America with French botanist Aimé Bonpland in 1799. Their five-year expedition laid the basis of plant geography. Humboldt believed observation *in situ* to be paramount, and used sophisticated instruments to make meticulous records of both plant and animal species, noting all the factors that could influence the data. This holistic approach is best illustrated in his highly detailed map and cross section of Chimborazo mountain in Ecuador.



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